



City Commission Agenda Report

City of Kalamazoo

Date: **4/1/2024**

Item: **H.4.**

TO: Mayor Anderson, Vice Mayor Hess, and City Commissioners

FROM: James K. Ritsema, ICMA-CM, City Manager
Reviewed by: James J. Baker, PE, Public Services Director and City Engineer
Prepared by: Anthony Ladd, PE, PMP, Public Works Division Manager

DATE: April 1, 2024

SUBJECT: Approve a contract with Wightman and Associates for the design of Michigan Avenue Two-Way Conversion for \$1,976,459. (Bid Ref#: 92549-002.0)

RECOMMENDATION:

It is recommended that the City Commission approve a contract with Wightman and Associates for the design of Michigan Avenue two-way conversion in the amount of \$1,976,459.

BACKGROUND:

For nearly 50 years the City of Kalamazoo has discussed and debated its one-way Downtown Street network. With the clear input from Imagine Kalamazoo 2025, control over our streets from the 2019 jurisdictional transfer, 2019-20 Street Network Design project input, and engineering reports supporting the resulting community vision, we are now well underway in making this a reality.

Michigan Avenue construction will follow Kalamazoo Avenue in schedule when it is completed in 2026, and also following the completed planned construction of Michikal in late 2024, W. Main Street, and Douglas Avenue in 2025. This project once completed, will be the final step in the two-way conversion of Michigan and Kalamazoo Avenue. Additional planning and design for Stadium Drive, South Street, Lovell Street, Westnedge Avenue, and Park Street are forthcoming.

This design work is funded through the RAISE planning and design grant that the City received in 2022.

In addition to the conversion from one way to two way traffic flow, pedestrian enhancements, and public space, this project will also include much needed water, sanitary sewer, and stormwater upgrades in alignment with our complete streets approach.

These changes meet the community's goals of streets that are safe and comfortable for all users.

This work will have a profound impact on economic vitality in and around Downtown and reconnect the Downtown with adjacent neighborhoods.

Seven proposals were received by the deadline given in the City's publicly issued and advertised Request for Proposal process. A comprehensive project team was assembled to review and compare the proposals using an MDOT approved qualifications-based selection method. Wightman's proposal had the highest cumulative score and was selected based on its conveyed understanding of the project scope, the firm's experience, and its project delivery abilities.

STRATEGIC VISION ALIGNMENT:

Strategic Goal Impact:

Shared Prosperity – Abundant opportunities for people to achieve shared prosperity

Safe Community – Creating a safe environment for living, working, and playing

Connected City – A city that is networked for walking, biking, riding, and driving

Economic Vitality – Growing businesses and stabilizing the local economy to the benefit of all

Good Governance – Making and implementing public decisions in ways that are collaborative, inclusive, and data-driven

Environmental Responsibility – A green and healthy city

COMMUNITY ENGAGEMENT:

Appropriate Depth of Engagement

Previously:

- IK 2025 Master Plan Engagement Process
- Focus group sessions and collaboration
- CDM Smith Street Design Project
- Website, social media ,and neighborhood meetings

Currently & Future:

- Public Information and Engagement Meetings
- Website, mailers, social media, and neighborhood/business meetings

Engagement/Communication Tools

Social media, website, mailers, focus group meetings, and public meetings

FISCAL IMPACT:

The funds required for this contract are \$1,976,459. Funds are from the previously approved

RAISE grant. The funding available and estimated costs are detailed below. We are requesting the approval of this purchase using the funds below.

Description	Account	Project #	Dollar Amount
Michigan Ave Design (RAISE grant)		MST0100271	\$1,976,459